

In case something happens

One page for whoever comes to help. Many families keep it on the refrigerator.

Who lives here

Full name Born

Lives alone? Languages spoken

Hearing aids, glasses, walker, memory notes

Getting in

Address, with apartment and floor

Door or gate code Who has a key

Building, manager or front desk Phone

Health

Medical conditions

Allergies, and what happens

Medication Dose and when

The full medication list is kept

People to call

Name and relationship Phone

Doctor and pharmacy

Doctor Phone

Pharmacy Phone

Also good to know

Pets in the home Preferred hospital

Insurance cards and papers are kept

For you, before you need it

Fill it in while nothing is wrong. This sheet is ten minutes on a calm afternoon or an impossible job during a frightening one. Most of it your parent knows cold and you half-know, which is exactly why it belongs on paper.

Put it where someone helping would look. The refrigerator door is the convention for a reason: people who come to help are used to checking it. A drawer keeps it private and keeps it useless.

Keep a copy yourself. If you're the one making calls from far away, you'll be asked for the address, the conditions, the medications and who has a key. Reading them off your copy beats trying to remember them while frightened.

Update it when the medications change. A sheet that lists last year's medicines is worse than no sheet, because it looks current. Rewrite the health block after any hospital visit and any new prescription.

Know where the bigger papers live. This page carries what helps in the first hour. Insurance documents, legal papers and the full medical history need a home too, and the line below is for writing down where that is.

The folder with the full papers is kept

Date filled in

Updated